

DATA, UNDIVIDED

❶ The new CPI series is expected to be published from the first quarter of 2026

sumption and demand patterns, which are not fully reflected in the current data sets.

“As the government is giving huge importance to data-driven decision-making, the role of MoSPI becomes very crucial,” underlines Garg. MoSPI is the nodal agency for the development of the statistical system in the country and is the administrative ministry for the National Statistics Office.

This is not all. The Census 2027 data will also be used by MoSPI in several ways, Garg said. First, it will be used extensively in updating the sampling frame of the

❷ Census 2027 data will also be used in updating the sampling frame of the national sample survey

out by the Office of Registrar General of India.

The next Census was planned for 2021 but had to be postponed due to the outbreak of Covid-19 pandemic. Since then, there have been several calls for the exercise to be conducted given the large time gap since the last Census.

Further, the Census results have use in GDP compilation, in addition to the use of the projected population figures in calculation of various per capita macro-economic indicators.

“The information on the number of dwellings from the Popula-

❸ MoSPI is also working to improve the frequency of surveys, as seen in the PLFS results

patterns and expenditure distributions used in the CPI and ICP, he further says. It will also help refine the sampling frames for price collection by offering more accurate rural-urban classifications and regional representation.

MoSPI is also working to improve the frequency of surveys. For instance, the Periodic Labour Force Survey results are now released monthly at all-India rural and urban level. The ministry also conducted an inaugural forward-looking capex survey in 2024, which it plans to now conduct annually. The next capex survey is likely to be conducted between September and November 2025, with survey notices expected to be issued by August 2025.

The Annual Survey of Service Sector Enterprises (ASSSE), which will offer valuable insights into the incorporated service sector of the economy, is planned starting January 2026.

A technical expert group has also been set up to advise on how to conduct the all-India income distribution survey, which is tentatively planned for 2026, Garg explains.

The impact of several of these measures, as well as the use of technology, is already visible, the most important being the much-needed monthly PLFS data. There is also faster turnaround in the IIP data, which is now released on the 28th of every month. The next year is likely to usher in more such improvements. **BT**

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national sample surveys by using the comprehensive list of villages for sampling in rural areas. “Also, auxiliary census details such as village population, proximity to district headquarters, would be used sample design and allow scientifically robust selection of samples,” he elaborates.

The last population Census was conducted in 2011 in two phases—House Listing (between April 1 to September 30, 2010, and Population Enumeration between February 9 and February 28, 2011. The next Census exercise is set to start in 2026 and will be carried

tion Census will be used for the estimation of GVA of Construction Sector and Gross Fixed Capital Formation (GFCF) under Dwellings, Other Buildings & Structures asset for the household sector,” he explains, adding that the inter-censal growth in the number of residential housing stock, derived from the Population Census, is used for the estimation of Gross Value Added (GVA) of Ownership of Dwellings.

The upcoming Census will provide updated population and household data, which will be crucial for updating the weighting

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